A dollar valuation at late stage is a funding structure, not a verdict on the technology.

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Early on, the company sets the price and capital follows. Late, the capital sets the price and the company grows into it, or doesn't.

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A fund that must deploy a very large sum can't buy 2% of a small company. It needs a company priced so its check fits.

Better than "is it justified by revenue multiples?": what kind of capital is this price built to absorb?

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Check before the pitch: Who led, and do they have to deploy? Would the round clear without the strategic name? What does the liquidation stack do to your slice? What if the same buyers don't return?

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> **A private mark is set by buyers inside the round. A public mark is set by a larger, less forgiving crowd. When they diverge, someone holds the difference.**

Sun Choi
Korea · Gulf · SEA · Central Asia